

Chennai, often called the “Detroit of South Asia,” boasts a rich automotive heritage and is home to renowned brands such as Hyundai, Renault Nissan, Mahindra, Yamaha and Bharat Benz. The Irungattukottai Racetrack, situated just outside the city limits, is a premier racing venue in the country and continues to host major national championships, including the popular MRF-F1600 formula series.

Being a motorsports hub of the country, a street race was long due. This long pending dream of the motorsports aficionados of the city was fulfilled as Chennai played host to South Asia’s first-ever Formula 4 street night race on 31st Aug and 1st Sep 2024. It doesn’t get any bigger than this as the Formula 4 cars zoomed around in the 3.5 km circuit passing through Island Grounds, War Memorial, Napier Bridge, Sivananda Salai, Mount Road and Flag Staff Road.

The anticipation of the race day reached a fever pitch as ticket sales opened on PayTM Insider, resulting in an overwhelming response from the public. With a high-octane atmosphere, the race blended the excitement of motorsport with the charm of Chennai’s streets, drawing attention from motorsport enthusiasts, residents, and international viewers alike.

Formula 4 is a developmental category for young drivers aiming to reach higher levels like Formula 3 and Formula 2, and it has a dedicated following. Fans who attended the race in person or watched it live expressed widespread enthusiasm for the format and setting. In the weeks leading up to the event, social media platforms were abuzz with anticipation. Fans from all over the region shared their excitement about experiencing high-speed racing on the city’s streets under lights.

As the city awaited the highly anticipated event with bated breath, the day began with exhilarating stunt shows, serving as a thrilling appetiser for what was yet to come. With the flag off by the Honourable Minister for Youth Welfare and Sports Development of the Government of Tamil Nadu, the streets of Chennai came alive last night as the highly anticipated Formula 4 Night Street Race unfolded under the city’s sparkling skyline. Racing enthusiasts from across the region flocked to the circuit, which was illuminated by dazzling floodlights that transformed the urban landscape into a high-octane racetrack.

The Chennai Formula Racing Circuit (CFRC), with its narrow lanes, sharp corners, and sudden elevation changes, proved a formidable challenge for the drivers. The races, spanning multiple laps of a 3.2-kilometer track, featured a mix of tight hairpin turns and long straightaways, making both strategy and precision essential for victory.

For many Chennaiites, the Formula 4 race was a point of pride. It was a rare opportunity to showcase their city to an international audience and put Chennai on the global motorsport map. The inaugural Formula 4 night street race in Chennai was a resounding success, drawing enthusiastic support from motorsport fans, residents, and the media. Chennai once again showcased its ability to host a large-scale international event, and the race has set the stage for future motorsport events in the city.

